

Wife-Carrying World Championships

Sonkajärvi, Finland
Male entrants carry their wives over an obstacle course. The winner receives his wife's weight in beer.

Baltai

Tatarstan, Russia
Baltai means "feast of honey." The festival marks the start of the mowing season and is celebrated by decorating a bear with birch leaves.

Chinese New Year

Called the Spring Festival in China, since it marks the end of winter, this festival typically involves street processions with lanterns and Chinese dragons. Families clean their houses to sweep away bad fortune and welcome in the New Year. The festival is celebrated in all countries with significant populations of Chinese people.



Locations with important Chinese New Year celebrations

Boryeong Mud Festival

Boryeong, South Korea
At this mucky festival, which dates from 1998, people cover each other in mud. The mud is said to contain minerals that are good for the skin.

Awa Odori

Tokushima, Japan
Awa Odori began in 1586, when Tokushima's residents decided to celebrate their town's new castle. Today, more than 1 million tourists visit to watch performers in traditional dress dance in the streets.

Bendigo Easter Festival

Bendigo, Australia
Dating from 1871, this is Australia's longest continuously running festival. During the festival's Easter procession, the *Sun Loong*, the longest imperial dragon in the world, dances through the streets of Bendigo.

Ghost Festival, China

Part of "Ghost Month," when the ghosts and spirits of dead ancestors are said to emerge from the underworld.

Janmashtami

Mumbai, India
Marks the birthday of the Hindu god Krishna. Boys and men clamber to the top of a pole, trying to smash a clay pot full of curd and spill its contents. Krishna is said to have stolen curd from pots as a boy.

Esala Maha Perahera

Kandy, Sri Lanka
The 10-day "Festival of the Tooth" celebrates the Tooth Relic of the Lord Buddha. Dancers, acrobats, and fire performers gather in Kandy. On the last night, an elegantly dressed elephant carries the tooth.

Incwala

Eswatini
At the "Festival of the first fruits," the king eats pumpkins and other fruits. People dance and sing in his honor and to bring blessings on the harvest.

Prickly Pear Festival

Mandela Bay, South Africa
This is a day for celebrating (and eating!) traditional foods such as ginger beer, pancakes, potjiekos, bunnychow, and fish braai.

World parties

Some festivals draw people from far and wide. They may be messy, such as Tomatina (left), or involve unusual competitions, such as wife-carrying.



Key world party sites